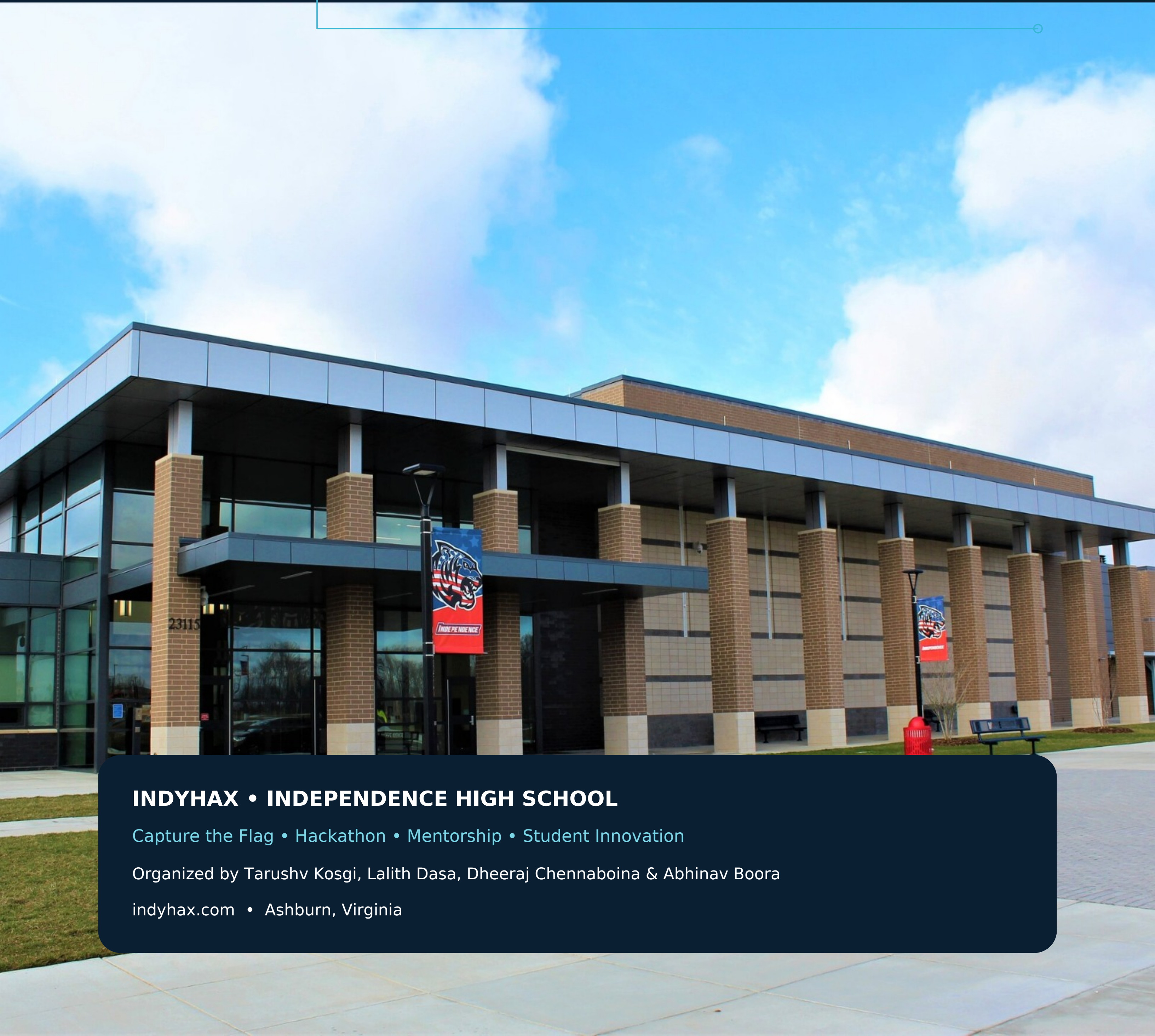
INDYHAX

2026–27 SPONSORSHIP PROSPECTUS

Two events. One student-led cybersecurity community.

WINTER CTF
Tentative • December 5, 2026

SUMMER FLAGSHIP
June / July 2027 • Date TBD



INDYHAX • INDEPENDENCE HIGH SCHOOL

Capture the Flag • Hackathon • Mentorship • Student Innovation

Organized by Tarushv Kosgi, Lalith Dasa, Dheeraj Chennaboina & Abhinav Boora

indyhax.com • Ashburn, Virginia

WHY PARTNER WITH INDYHAX

A Letter to Prospective Partners

Thank you for considering support for IndyHAX, a student-led cybersecurity competition hosted at Independence High School. IndyHAX was created to give high school students a place to do more than learn cybersecurity in theory: they can solve real challenges, build under time pressure, work as a team, and interact with mentors already studying and working in the field.

The inaugural IndyHAX in June 2026 brought together 67 students across 18 teams for a hybrid Capture the Flag and hackathon. Students tackled Jeopardy-style cybersecurity challenges while other teams built technology projects around the event prompt. George Mason University Cyber Security Engineering supported the event, and faculty and student volunteers helped mentor and judge participants.

For the 2026–27 season, we plan to expand the program into two events: a smaller, focused CTF with a tentative date of December 5, 2026, followed by a larger summer flagship IndyHAX in June or July 2027. This structure lets us create a lower-barrier winter competition while preserving the full hybrid experience for the summer event.

Sponsor support directly improves the student experience. Funding can underwrite prizes, meals, challenge infrastructure, event materials, workshop hardware, and the costs of running two safe, well-organized competitions. In-kind support is equally valuable, especially hardware, cloud credits, food, prizes, mentors, judges, and technical demonstrations.

> **Our goal is simple: make serious cybersecurity practice accessible to students before college, and build a community where beginners and experienced competitors can learn from one another.**

Sincerely,

The IndyHAX Organizing Team

Independence High School • Ashburn, Virginia

COMPETITION + COMMUNITY

What Is IndyHAX?

IndyHAX is a student-led cybersecurity and technology event built around two complementary ways to compete: solving security challenges and building original projects. The flagship format gives students the flexibility to specialize in one track or engage with both.

CAPTURE THE FLAG

Jeopardy-style cybersecurity challenges that test cryptography, forensics, web security, networking, reverse engineering, and problem-solving. Participants earn points by finding and submitting flags.

BUILD YOUR IDEA

A time-boxed hackathon where teams turn ideas into working technology projects. The event emphasizes technical execution, creativity, teamwork, and the ability to explain what was built.

THE HYBRID MODEL

Teams can focus on the CTF, build a project, or combine both. The model rewards different strengths while keeping everyone inside the same high-energy event environment.

67
COMPETITORS
In the inaugural 2026 event.

18
TEAMS
Competing across the event.

≤4
TEAM SIZE
Up to four students per team under current event rules.

Built for learning, fairness, and safety

- CTF activity is restricted to the official competition environment; school networks, personal devices, public websites, and unrelated systems are off-limits.
- Participants are expected to compete fairly, credit outside tools and assets when relevant, and follow Independence High School and LCPS rules.
- Mentors, judges, and university volunteers can help students connect technical work to real cybersecurity study and careers.

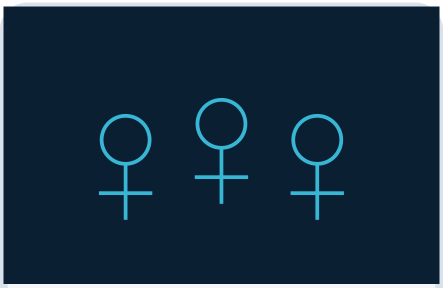
THE FIRST INDYHAX

2026 Legacy & Impact

The inaugural IndyHAX at Independence High School established the format we want to grow: technical competition, student-built projects, university mentorship, meaningful prizes, and a professional event experience organized by students.

67	18	2	1
STUDENTS	TEAMS	COMPETITION TRACKS	INAUGURAL EVENT

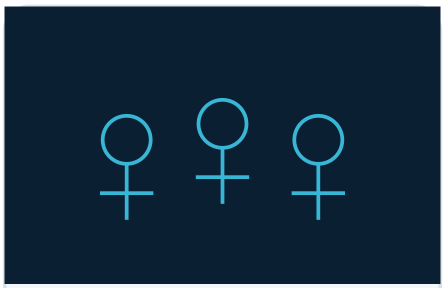
Official 2026 Legacy Gallery (click any panel to open the original photo)



Organizing Team

Core organizers and event staff after the 2026 competition.

OPEN PHOTO ↗



Judging & Mentorship

Judges and mentors reviewing student work during IndyHAX 2026.

OPEN PHOTO ↗

Award Ceremony

A 2026 winning team receiving iPad prizes.

OPEN PHOTO ↗

Explore the full legacy archive

The IndyHAX Legacy page includes the 2026 photo archive and press coverage. George Mason University also highlighted the event as a student cybersecurity pipeline and noted the role of university mentors and volunteers.

indyhax.com/legacy.html

TWO EVENTS, TWO PURPOSES

2026–27 Event Plan

Rather than making every IndyHAX identical, the next season is designed as a progression: a smaller winter CTF that keeps students practicing, followed by a larger summer flagship event that restores the full hybrid format and broader sponsor activation.

EVENT 01 • WINTER

Focused CTF Competition

Tentative: Saturday, December 5, 2026

- Smaller event centered on Jeopardy-style Capture the Flag challenges.
- Designed to create a clear competitive checkpoint during the school year.
- Lower logistical footprint than the flagship event, allowing sponsor dollars to concentrate on challenge infrastructure, prizes, and participant experience.
- A strong entry point for students who want to try cybersecurity competition without committing to a full hybrid hackathon.

EVENT 02 • SUMMER FLAGSHIP

IndyHAX Hybrid CTF + Hackathon

Planned for June or July 2027 • Final date TBD

- Return of the full hybrid format: Capture the Flag, project building, judging, and awards.
- More room for mentors, university partners, judges, sponsor tables, demos, and student showcases.
- Designed to scale the event beyond the inaugural year while keeping the student-led character that made IndyHAX distinctive.
- Potential for expanded challenge categories, technical workshops, and deeper sponsor involvement as planning is finalized.

Dates and final formats are planning targets and remain subject to Independence High School / LCPS approval and event logist

EDUCATIONAL & COMMUNITY IMPACT

Why Sponsorship Matters

IndyHAX is not just a prize competition. Sponsor support creates experiences that are difficult to reproduce in a normal class period: sustained technical problem-solving, real-time teamwork, outside mentorship, judging, and exposure to what cybersecurity looks like beyond high school.

Hands-on cyber practice

Students apply concepts through challenge solving, debugging, investigation, and technical communication.

Mentorship & pathways

University faculty, students, and industry volunteers can help participants connect event skills to college programs and careers.

Confidence through competition

Beginners get a structured first competition; experienced students get a higher ceiling and stronger peer community.

Student leadership

Planning, challenge design, logistics, web infrastructure, judging coordination, and sponsor outreach are themselves leadership experiences.

Ways partners can contribute beyond a check

- Provide mentors or judges with cybersecurity, software, engineering, or entrepreneurship experience.
- Donate prizes, hardware, cloud credits, software licenses, food, printing, or event materials.
- Host a technical demo or approved workshop that gives students a realistic view of current tools and careers.
- Share internship-independent education pathways, college programs, certifications, scholarships, and student opportunities.

2026 partnership in action

George Mason University reported that its cybersecurity faculty and student volunteers helped organize, mentor, and judge IndyHAX 2026, giving high school participants direct exposure to collegiate cybersecurity education.

A PRACTICAL TWO-EVENT BUDGET

Funding Plan & Sponsorship Levels

The following is a working planning budget for sponsor outreach. Final spending will depend on event size, donated goods and services, school approval, and the final summer format.

CATEGORY	TARGET	USE
Winter CTF prizes & awards	**$2,000**	Student/team prizes and recognition for the December competition.
Summer flagship prizes & awards	**$4,000**	Awards for CTF, hackathon, and hybrid categories.
Meals & refreshments	**$2,400**	Participant and volunteer food across two events.
CTF infrastructure & cloud	**$1,000**	Hosting, challenge services, domains, cloud credits, and technical infrastructure.
Event materials & printing	**$800**	Badges, signage, table materials, supplies, and sponsor recognition.
Workshop / hardware materials	**$1,200**	Hands-on technical materials for the summer event and demos.
Contingency	**$600**	Unplanned event costs and last-mile logistics.
WORKING TWO-EVENT SPONSORSHIP TARGET	**$12,000**	

Suggested sponsorship levels

COMMUNITY	SILVER	GOLD	PLATINUM	PRESENTING
$250	**$500**	**$1,000**	**$2,500**	**$5,000+**
or equivalent in-kind	or equivalent in-kind	or equivalent in-kind	or equivalent in-kind	or equivalent in-kind

All sponsorship benefits, naming, on-site activity, and payment handling are subject to school and LCPS policies and final approval

BUILD THE NEXT INDYHAX WITH US

Sponsor Benefits & Next Steps

We want sponsor recognition to be meaningful without turning a student event into an advertisement. Benefits are structured around visibility, student access, and practical involvement, with final placements subject to school approval.

BENEFIT	COMM.	SILVER	GOLD	PLAT.	PRES.
Logo on IndyHAX sponsor page	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Recognition on event slides	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Logo on approved event signage	—	✓	✓	✓	✓
Swag / material inclusion	—	✓	✓	✓	✓
Priority mentor / judge invitations	—	—	✓	✓	✓
On-site table or technical demo	—	—	—	✓	✓
Top-tier placement across both events	—	—	—	—	✓
Customized sponsor activation	—	—	—	—	✓

NEXT STEP

Start a sponsorship conversation

Visit the IndyHAX sponsorship page or legacy archive to review current supporters, event history, and contact options. We can tailor a partnership around funding, prizes, food, hardware, cloud resources, mentors, judges, or technical programming.

SPONSORSHIP: **indyhax.com/sponsors.html**

LEGACY: **indyhax.com/legacy.html**

SCAN FOR LEGACY ARCHIVE

Sponsor interest / internal routing

ORGANIZATION

CONTACT NAME / TITLE

EMAIL / PHONE

PREFERRED SPONSORSHIP LEVEL

IN-KIND CONTRIBUTION (IF ANY)

MENTOR / JUDGE / DEMO INTEREST

If there is any interest in sponsoring or supporting IndyHAX, please email lalith@indyhax.com.